LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer

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PROFILE

Senior data engineer with 9 years of experience designing, building, and operating production batch and streaming data platforms for e-commerce and payments, including Airflow, dbt, Kafka, Snowflake, AWS, and Python. Builds reusable, well-tested pipelines with clear data contracts, reliable cloud warehouses, and data quality practices that analysts and product teams can trust.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer - Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o., Rijeka *03/2022 - present*

- Own the ingestion layer of the company data platform: ~140 Airflow DAGs loading from Postgres, MySQL, Salesforce and 3rd-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Moved transformation logic from stored procedures to dbt (420+ models, tests on every model); nightly run time down from 5h10 to 1h50.
- Introduced data contracts between product teams and the data team (JSON Schema + CI checks), cutting broken-pipeline incidents from ~9/month to ~2/month.
- Built a Kafka-based event pipeline for shipment tracking events using Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming, processing approximately 30M events/day with p95 end-to-end latency under 2 minutes; added dead-letter and replay tooling to reprocess failed events without data loss.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts with Debezium CDC from PostgreSQL into Kafka and Snowflake, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Contributed two merged fixes and tests to an open-source Airflow provider package, including a pagination fix for a SaaS CRM API.
- Mentor two mid-level data engineers; run the weekly data platform office hours.
- Participate in the data-platform on-call rotation, one week in six.
- Reduced Snowflake costs from about $38k/month to $24k/month through warehouse sizing and auto-suspend.

Data Engineer - Kovalent Pay, Zagreb *09/2019 - 02/2022*

- Built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile approximately 1.2 TB/day of settlement files against internal ledgers, reducing finance team's manual month-end reconciliation from about 3 days to 4 hours.
- Designed the Redshift warehouse schema (star schema, 30+ fact/dimension tables) used by finance and risk.
- Set up data quality checks with Great Expectations on critical finance tables.
- Wrote internal Python library for S3/Glue catalog access used by 4 teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer - Adria Retail Group, Split *06/2017 - 08/2019*

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL into an on-prem SQL Server warehouse.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations (40+ stores).
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) - Northgate Technical University, 2017
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate (May 2024)

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash | Data platform: Airflow, dbt, Spark/PySpark, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Great Expectations, Debezium, pytest
Cloud & infra: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions
BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native), English (C1), German (B1)